

Week 5.1

Grammar: The passive voice

Vocabulary: Marketing

Pronunciation: Word stress in adjective + compound noun phrases

Work in groups. Read the descriptions of different ways to collect or process water. Which ones are you familiar with? Which are new to you? Which of the systems are already in use in your country. Where?

- **fog nets:** When fog hits large nets, it condenses into water and falls into pipes for collection in large tanks.
- **desalination plant:** Salt water from the sea is processed to take out the salt and produce fresh water.
- **dam:** A dam is built on a river to form a reservoir.
- **groundwater collection:** Tanks are built at the bottoms of mountains or hills to collect water when it rains.
- **residential rainwater collection tank:** Rainwater on the roofs of houses is collected in tanks.

Discuss the questions.

1. In what countries or geographical areas within a country would each of the water systems be most appropriate?
 - fog nets
 - desalination plant
 - dam
 - groundwater collection
 - residential rainwater collection tank
2. What do you think are the advantages and disadvantages of each system?
3. Do any areas in your country have problems with water shortages? If so, which of the systems in the photos do you think would work the best in those areas? Why?

Grammar: The passive voice

“Pakistan Under Water”

In August 2013, large areas of Pakistan were under water as the country suffered from severe flooding yet again. The floods were caused by unusually heavy monsoon rains. Over 200 people were killed, and it is estimated that 80,000 houses and 1.5 million acres of crops were damaged or destroyed. Approximately 1.5 million people were affected in some way by the disaster.

When the 2013 floods occurred, much of the damage caused by the previous year's flooding had not yet been repaired, which increased their impact. However, several years of severe flooding had improved the response to the disaster.

Since 2013, many houses, buildings and roads have been rebuilt, but the main focus is on reducing the risk of further damage in the event of extreme weather in the future. Dams and other water channels are being constructed to help control large amounts of rainwater, however, lack of funding remains an issue. To minimise future risk, people are being advised not to build in very low-lying areas or near rivers and canals.

We use the passive voice when...

- we do not know the person doing the action
- the person doing the action is not important at all
- we are describing a natural phenomenon

Complete the sentences with the correct passive form of the verbs in brackets. There may be more than one correct answer.

1. My town _____ (hit) by heavy rains every year, and sometimes we have terrible floods.
2. About 50 people _____ (kill) in floods here in the past five years.
3. We had a flood six months ago, but most people _____ (evacuate) before the flood started.
4. Thousands of buildings _____ (destroy) by the flood.
5. The devastation was particularly bad because buildings _____ already _____ (damage) by last year's floods.
6. Most of the businesses affected _____ (reopen) now.
7. The shopping centre _____ (rebuild) and will reopen next year.
8. A system of canals _____ (construct) to catch rainwater.

Work in pairs. Do research on a water-related disaster. Make sure that you can answer these questions:

- What area was affected?
- What kind of damage was caused?
- How many lives were lost?
- What kinds of reconstruction efforts have been made?
- What kinds of work are still being done?



A blonde woman with long, wavy hair, wearing a white, sleeveless, draped dress, is smiling and looking towards the camera. She is positioned on the left side of the advertisement.

I am what I drink

Everyday, I renew my body with a water of supreme purity,
coming from the pristine heights of the French Alps.

Evian. Your Natural Source of Youth.



**Filled with
Volcanicity**



Vocabulary: Marketing

Complete the statements with the correct forms of the words and phrases from the box.

1. Companies shouldn't _____ water _____ something special.
2. I would buy bottled water that _____ £1.50 _____ £3, but no more.
3. I like buying things in _____ containers because I use them as decorations.
4. An exclusive container can _____ a product _____ a higher price.
5. Sometimes my decision to buy a product is _____ the packaging _____ about the product itself.
6. There's no such thing as a '_____' product. Companies will always produce more if there is a market for it.

limited-edition ~ specially-designed ~ to be more about ... than ~
to make ... worth ~ to market as ~ to range from ... to

Work in groups. Discuss whether you agree or disagree with these statements.

1. Companies shouldn't _____ water _____ something special.
2. I would buy bottled water that _____ £1.50 _____ £3, but no more.
3. I like buying things in _____ containers because I use them as decorations.
4. An exclusive container can _____ a product _____ a higher price.
5. Sometimes my decision to buy a product is _____ the packaging _____ about the product itself.
6. There's no such thing as a '_____' product. Companies will always produce more if there is a market for it.

Pronunciation: Word stress in adjective +
compound noun phrases

Listen to the phrases. Which word is stressed in each phrase? Listen again and check your ideas, then work in pairs and practise saying the phrases.

- clean drinking water
- trendy water bottles
- large fog nets
- underground water tanks
- public water supply
- new marketing techniques



Practise the sentences. Make sure you stress the second word in each underlined phrase. Then listen and check.

- We all want a good public water supply with clean drinking water.
- New marketing techniques include designing trendy water bottles.
- Underground water tanks and large fog nets are two ways to collect water.

